

Väinö Rikkonen

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Work Experience

CGI - Infrastructure Architect

Helsinki, Finland

February 2026 - Present

- Leading the transformation of a legacy Cisco UCS infrastructure to a modern Nutanix HCI platform, covering architecture, migration planning, network design, service transition, and implementation strategy.
- Designed, architected, and engineered a remote access VPN modernization from a legacy VPN platform to a SASE-based solution supporting approximately 4,000 users.
- Re-engineered CGI's shared Internet infrastructure to support BFD-based fast failure detection, improving resiliency, reducing routing convergence times, and enhancing availability for shared Internet services.

CGI - Network Designer

Helsinki, Finland

April 2024 - February 2026

- Developed and implemented network performance telemetry monitoring dashboards with TIG (Telegraf, Influxdb, Grafana) stack to proactively identify and resolve performance bottlenecks within the datacenter network.
- Improved network performance and efficiency within CGI data centers by optimizing L2 and L3 topology.
- Identified cost-saving opportunities by consolidating physical connections and equipment closer together inside data centers.
- Troubleshoot and solved complex network-related escalated incidents & problems.
- Developed network automation solutions using Ansible and Python to reduce the risk of human error while deploying configuration changes and upgrading software on network devices.
- Successfully designed and implemented networks that ensured high availability, scalability and reliability for CGI services.
- Served as the technical lead for projects where network equipment was installed, decommissioned, upgraded or relocated.
- Documented network environments, including network topology, configuration, IPAM and DCIM.
- Communicated network related maintenance and production changes to stakeholders.
- On-boarded and mentored new team members to ensure they had the necessary skills to maintain and troubleshoot network equipment and systems.
- Provided on-call support to ensure timely resolution of network issues outside of business hours.

Google - Data Center Technician L3

Hamina, Finland

January 2023 - April 2024

- Diagnosed and repaired data center servers, network devices, fibers, cables, optics, racks, rectifiers, batteries, and inverters.
- Securely handled, destroyed and shipped hard drives and other media to ensure data security.
- Successfully deployed new machine learning server and network infrastructure ahead of schedule, and conducted quality assurance testing to ensure the systems were functioning properly.
- Improved processes, tools, safety and workflows to increase efficiency, reduce downtime and lower operating costs globally across the company.
- Escalated issues with the potential to disrupt company production clusters on a global scale.
- Documented known issues, lessons learned, diagnose- and repair guides to facilitate knowledge sharing and continuous improvement globally across the company.
- Network maintenance technical lead with responsibility for maintaining SLAs and SLOs and serving as the team's expert in network maintenance.
- Embarked on international travel to participate in advanced datacenter server maintenance training and subsequently trained others on the acquired knowledge.
- Provided weekend shift support for local data center server operations, serving as the primary point of contact for vendors.
- Provided on-call support to ensure timely resolution of datacenter issues outside of business hours.
- Interviewed candidates to assess their technical expertise, problem-solving abilities, communication skills and if they would be a good fit for Google's culture.

CGI - Data Networking Engineer

Helsinki, Finland

June 2021 - December 2022

- Installed, configured, and maintained various network equipment, including switches, routers, load balancers, firewalls, wireless access points and controllers.
- Troubleshoot and solved complex network-related incidents & problems.
- Successfully implemented network designs that ensured high availability, scalability and reliability.
- Monitored network health using various tools to identify potential issues and proactively take action to prevent network downtime.
- Documented network environments, including network topology, configuration, IPAM and wireless heatmaps.
- Served as the technical lead for projects where datacenter network equipment was installed, decommissioned, upgraded or moved to a different location.
- Served as the primary point of contact for all Cisco datacenter network equipment and software issues, including troubleshooting, RMA requests, and technical support escalations.
- Communicated network related maintenance and production changes to stakeholders.
- On-boarded and mentored new team members to ensure they had the necessary skills to maintain and troubleshoot network equipment and systems.
- Developed network automation solutions using Ansible and Python to streamline network operations and reduce the workload on the team.
- Provided on-call support to ensure timely resolution of network issues outside of business hours.

Education

Omnia Vocational College

Vocational Qualification in Business Information Technology

Espoo, Finland